PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“SCHWA” /ə/ Spelling

The spelling of the schwa or /ə/ “uh” varies dramatically and is spread out in frequency amongst all vowels.

For example, we substitute the schwa for the letters:

“o”	e.g. occur	> “uh ker”
“a”	e.g. yoga	> “yow guh”
“i”	e.g. animal	> “an uh mul”
“e”	e.g. remember	> “ruh mem ber”
“ou”	e.g. famous	> “fay muhs”
“u”	e.g. support	> “suh port”

So you can see why spelling is not your best bet for finding those pesky schwa sounds. The best way to identify the schwa sound is to find the unstressed syllable.

E.g.
America

A MER ica (stress is in the “mer”

The schwa is heard in the other syllables:

“uh MER “uh” “kuh”